



The Quiet Vale

Seasons of Settlement

Draft Rulebook for Playtest Review

A game of stewardship, renewal, and hard choices after the old realm
falls quiet.

Styled PDF draft v0.1 - generated from the current Codex prototype repository.

Welcome To The Vale

DRAFT STATUS

This is a styled playtest rulebook draft generated from the current prototype data. It is suitable for review and table testing, but not yet locked production wording.

The players guide a settlement through three Seasons. Over 15 rounds, players seed and reveal Encounter Cards, place and improve tiles on the hex map, manage a shared Warehouse, complete Arrivals to unlock Special Tiles, and resolve or endure Burdens.

The final score is Population plus Renown, reduced by unresolved active Burdens and remaining Strain.

At A Glance

Topic	Rule
Players	Standard game supports 1-4 players.
Length	3 Seasons, 15 rounds total.
Actions	Each player has 4 Actions per round.
Resources	Wood, Stone, Metal, Food, Herbs, Goods. Warehouse maximum is 15 of each.
Strain	3 Strain makes a tile Overstrained.
Final burden penalty	6 Renown per unresolved active Burden.
Final Strain penalty	2 Renown per Strain token.

Components

Component	Qty	Notes
Map board	1	Redesigned Basic Map v0.2; 126 flat-top hexes; Arable Land: 6, Grasslands: 75, Heaths: 6, Mountains: 6, Ruins: 6, Water: 21, Woodland: 6
Core tile pieces	54	Double-sided Basic/Upgraded pieces.
Special tile pieces	26	One-sided tiles unlocked by Arrivals.
Encounter Cards	80	Arrival: 25, Boon: 25, Burden: 25, Golden Boon: 5.
Warehouse resources	TBD	Wood, Stone, Metal, Food, Herbs, Goods. Prototype cap: 15 of each.
Strain tokens	TBD	3 Strain makes a tile Overstrained.
Arrival timer tokens	TBD	Arrivals begin with 3 timer tokens.
Steward markers	1/player	Track each player's Steward location / last interacted tile.
Supported markers	TBD	Used for manual or passive Supported state.

Grasslands	Woodland	Heaths	Water / River	Mountains	Arable Land	Ruins
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Setup

1. Choose 1-4 players.
2. Use Redesigned Basic Map v0.2 as the default locked map.
3. Place all directly placeable Core Basic tiles in the tile supply. Upgraded faces are used only when tiles are upgraded.
4. Keep Special Tiles locked until their matching Arrival is completed.
5. Stock the shared Warehouse using the table below. The Warehouse maximum remains 15 of each resource.
6. Build a balanced standard Encounter pool with 5 Boons, 5 Burdens, and 5 Arrivals per player.
7. Shuffle the standard pool. Deal 10 hidden Encounter Cards to each player.
8. Deal 5 standard Encounter Cards per player to the Encounter Deck.
9. Add exactly 1 random Golden Boon to the Encounter Deck. Golden Boons are never dealt to player hands.
10. Start at Round 1, Season I, Seed Encounters phase.

Player count	Starting Warehouse
1	15 of each resource
2	10 of each resource
3	5 of each resource
4	0 of each resource
5+ Council Variant	0 of each resource

Round And Season Structure

Season I is rounds 1-5, Season II is rounds 6-10, and Season III is rounds 11-15. Each round follows the same structure:

1. Seed Encounter Cards.
2. Reveal Encounters.
3. Player Turns.
4. End of Round.

SEASON PRESSURE

At the start of Rounds 6 and 11, unresolved active Burdens reapply using the new Season's text.

Encounter Cards

Seed Encounters

During the Seed Encounters phase, each player contributes 1 hidden Encounter Card from their hand if able. A round can seed Encounter Cards only once. The prototype allows deck-position choices for testing; final production wording should confirm the exact insertion method.

Reveal Encounters

During Reveal Encounters, reveal standard Encounter Cards equal to the player count. Golden Boons are extra reveals: they do not count toward the standard reveal total, and revealing continues until the required number of standard cards has appeared.

Encounter type	Cards
Arrival	25
Boon	25
Burden	25
Golden Boon	5
Total	80

Encounter Types

- Boon: resolve the current Season effect. If it modifies a future action, keep it visible until used or expired by its text.
- Burden: apply the current Season effect, then place it as an active Burden unless the card says otherwise.
- Arrival: place it as an active Arrival with 3 timer tokens.
- Golden Boon: resolve its bespoke effect as an extra reveal.

Player Turns And Actions

During Player Turns, each player receives 4 Actions for the round. Unspent Actions do not carry forward.

- Place a Tile.
- Upgrade a Tile.
- Activate a Tile.
- Complete an Arrival.
- Resolve a Burden.
- Use a Steward Power.
- Travel to a disconnected tile as part of a tile action.
- Cross a river without a Bridge connection when applicable.

Map, Terrain, And River

Terrain	Hexes	Role
Grasslands	75	Default open ground
Water / River	21	River / water barrier
Woodland	6	Forests / wooded terrain
Mountains	6	Mountain terrain
Heaths	6	Heath / wild scrubland
Arable Land	6	Fields / cultivated land
Ruins	6	Old stones / ruins

Water/River hexes: D1, D2, E3, F3, E4, G4, H4, E5, I5, J5, E6, K6, L6, E7, L7, E8, F8, M8, N8, G9, H9. Every Water/River hex is a legal potential Bridge placement site. Bridge Candidate markers are optional review/test annotations only, not placement restrictions.

- Use flat-top hex adjacency only.
- No tile may be placed on a River/Water hex unless the tile explicitly permits Water/River placement.
- Bridge is the normal tile placed on a Water/River hex and is a Travel Tile.
- Placed, non-Overstrained tiles adjacent to a Bridge connect through that Bridge, including across the river.
- An Overstrained Bridge loses Travel connectivity.
- Crossing the river without a Bridge connection costs 1 Action.

Tiles And The Settlement Network

Place A Tile

1. Choose an available tile.
2. Choose a legal empty footprint on the map.
3. Pay the tile's resource cost from the shared Warehouse.
4. Spend the Place action cost.
5. If the placement is disconnected from the player's travel access, spend the disconnected Travel action cost unless a rule waives it.
6. Place the tile, reduce its stock, and move the acting player's Steward marker to that tile.

A tile must obey its printed terrain and adjacency restrictions. Multihex tiles must keep their full footprint on legal empty hexes. Single-hex tiles do not require rotation.

Connected Settlement Network

All placed, non-Overstrained tiles create the connected settlement network when connected by side adjacency. Travel Tiles remain a tile category and component identity, but they are no longer the only tiles that carry reachability. Active Bridges and eligible Docks connect networks according to their printed rules.

**STEWARDS
LOCATION**

The acting player's current Steward tile anchors local access. After a disconnected placement, the Steward moves there, so that same tile can later be upgraded or activated without paying the disconnected Travel action again.

Overstrained tiles do not contribute to the connected settlement network.

Upgrade A Tile

1. Choose a placed tile with a matching Upgraded face.
2. The tile must not be Overstrained.
3. Pay the listed upgrade resource cost, if any.
4. Spend the Upgrade action cost.
5. If the tile is disconnected from the player's travel access, spend the disconnected Travel action cost unless the tile is the acting player's Steward tile or another rule waives the cost.
6. Replace the placed Basic face with its Upgraded face while preserving its map position and state.

Resource tile upgrades cost only the Upgrade action when their source cost is 0.

Activate A Tile

1. Choose a placed tile with a supported activation effect.
2. The tile must not be Overstrained.
3. Spend the Activate action cost.
4. If the tile is disconnected from the player's travel access, spend the disconnected Travel action cost unless the tile is the acting player's Steward tile or another rule waives the cost.
5. Resolve the tile's printed effect and move the Steward marker to that tile.

Warehouse, Strain, And Supported

The shared Warehouse stores Wood, Stone, Metal, Food, Herbs, and Goods. The Warehouse cap is 15 per resource unless a rule explicitly changes that cap. Costs are paid from the shared Warehouse. Gains cannot exceed the cap.

- A tile with 3 Strain is Overstrained.
- Overstrained tiles cannot activate or upgrade.
- Overstrained tiles do not provide passive effects.
- Overstrained tiles do not contribute Population or Renown to final scoring.
- Overstrained tiles do not contribute to the connected settlement network or provide Travel-specific benefits.
- Overstrained tiles cannot receive more Strain.
- Supported prevents the first Strain placed on a tile each round. Supported use resets at end of round.

Burdens

When a Burden is revealed, apply its current Season effect. If it has a supported reveal choice, resolve or record that choice. Then place the card as an active Burden unless its text says otherwise.

Burdens that place Strain can affect disconnected or unreachable tiles unless the card says otherwise. If fewer valid targets exist than requested, choose all valid targets. If no valid targets exist, no Strain is placed, but the Burden remains active unless resolved.

If a Burden has a supported resolution cost, a player may resolve it by paying the listed requirement and spending the listed action cost. Resolved Burdens leave active play and do not reapply at future Season starts. Some source Burdens are persistent active Burdens and cannot be resolved by the player.

Arrivals

When an Arrival is revealed, place it as an active Arrival with 3 timer tokens. Timer tokens cannot exceed 3.

1. Fulfill the Arrival requirement all at once.
2. Spend 1 Action to complete it.
3. Pay any required resources.
4. Move the Arrival to completed state.
5. Unlock its matching Special Tile.

At end of round, remove 1 timer token from each active Arrival. Failed Arrivals with no remaining timer tokens expire.

Golden Boons

Golden Boons are special Encounter Cards added to the deck during setup. They are not dealt to player hands and do not count as standard reveals.

Golden Boon	Effect
The Golden Bell	Reveal an eligible Arrival from the game box as an active Arrival.
The Golden Eyed Traveler	Open one additional Player Turns phase before end-of-round effects.
The Golden Scroll	Refresh selected standard cards in player hands.
The Golden Signet Ring	Relocate up to 5 placed tiles while preserving tile state and obeying map restrictions.
The Golden Vial	Create a rest-of-game, once-per-round disconnected Travel action discount.

Steward Houses And Powers

The current prototype represents Steward Tokens as each player's last-interaction marker. The upgraded Steward House powers are:

Steward House	Power
Vanguard Home	Once per Season, eligible Travel or Resource placement costs 0 Actions.

Steward House	Power
Knight Home	Once per Season, eligible Housing placement costs 0 Actions.
Sentinel Home	Once per Season, eligible Core upgrade costs 0 Actions.
Ranger Home	Once per Season, disconnected placement can ignore the extra Travel action.
Quartermaster Home	Once per Season, exchange up to 3 Warehouse resources.
Warden Home	Once per Season, resolve an active Burden without spending an Action.

End Of Round

1. Remove 1 timer token from each active Arrival.
2. Expire failed Arrivals with no timer tokens remaining.
3. Discard Boons that expire at end of round.
4. Reset per-round Supported use.
5. Reset once-per-round effects such as The Golden Vial.
6. Advance to the next round, or complete the game after Round 15.

Final Scoring

1. Add Population from non-Overstrained placed tiles.
2. Add Renown from non-Overstrained placed tiles.
3. Subtract 6 Renown for each unresolved active Burden.
4. Subtract 2 Renown for each Strain token on the board.

SCORE FORMULA Final score = Population + Renown - active Burden penalties - Strain penalties.

Arrival Unlock Reference

Use this reference when players complete Arrivals and unlock Special Tiles. Each Arrival normally has three rounds to complete after it is revealed.

Arrival	Requirement	Unlocked Special Tile
Acorns & Oak Trees	2 Herbs, 2 Stone, and 2 Goods	Shrine of Renewal
Battle to Cattle	2 Wood, 2 Metal, and 2 Food	The Tamers' Respite
Before the Last Age	2 Stone, 2 Metal, and 2 Goods	Shrine of Ancestors
Blade to Herb	2 Wood, 2 Metal, and 2 Food	The Root Weavers Respite
Blessed Harvest	2 Food and 4 Stone	Shrine of Bounty
Burden-Bearers	Have at least 1 Housing Tile and pay 2 Herbs, 2 Stone and 2 Metal	The Resting Hall
Dark Decay to Light	2 Wood, 2 Stone, and 2 Food	The Lorekeepers' Respite
Hands for Heavy Work	2 Food, 2 Stone, and 2 Goods	Labourers' Yard
Hearthbound Circle	4 Herbs, 4 Food	Hearth Garden
Lanterns for Roads	2 Wood, 2 Metal, and 2 Goods	Lantern Roadhouse
Lest We Forget	4 Wood and 4 Metal	Theatre
Moving Mountains	2 Food, 2 Stone, and 2 Goods	Shrine of Depths
News Travels Faster	2 Food and 4 Goods	The Waystation
No Soul Goes Unserved	2 Goods and 2 Herbs	Alms House
Plunderer to Lumber	2 Wood, 2 Metal, and 2 Food	The Reavers' Respite
Quiet Quest	4 Goods	Adventurers' Guild
Reablement for the Vale	4 Wood and 4 Metal	Atelier Workshop
Remnants of the Cavalry	2 Wood, 4 Herbs, and 2 Goods	Stables
Remnants of the Fleet	2 Wood, 4 Herbs, and 2 Goods	Docks
Repurpose Tools	2 Metal and 2 Goods	Reliquary
Songs of War to Ore	2 Wood, 2 Metal, and 2 Food	The Iron Roots Respite
Spirit-Lifting	2 Wood, 2 Metal and 2 Goods	Brewery of Legends
Strong Foundations	2 Goods and 2 Herbs	House of Learning
The Dryads	2 Herbs, 2 Stone, and 2 Goods	Shrine of Ancients
Transmutation Traveller	2 Herbs and 2 Goods	Alchemist's Workshop

Production Notes To Resolve

- Confirm exact final seeding wording and deck insertion method.
- Confirm physical token quantities for resources, Strain, timers, Supported markers, and Steward/player markers.
- Run final copy-editing on all card-facing text.
- Confirm whether last-interaction marker language should become final Steward Token language or remain prototype language.
- Confirm final component naming for the map board and any player aids.